Burak Üren

Backend Engineer

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SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 3+ years of professional experience building scalable REST APIs, asynchronous microservices, and payment-integrated systems with Django and Flask in Agile/Scrum teams. Founded and still operate a production marketplace platform serving 5,000+ users end to end, from API design to deployment and server hardening.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages	Python, SQL, Bash
Frameworks	Django, Django REST Framework, Flask, SQLAlchemy, Alembic, Celery, HTMX
Data & Messaging	PostgreSQL, Redis, RabbitMQ, pandas
Cloud & Infra	AWS (RDS, S3, EKS, ElastiCache), DigitalOcean, Docker, Docker Compose, Kubernetes, Caddy, Nginx, Cloudflare, Linux
CI/CD & Quality	GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Git, pytest, factory-boy, black, flake8, isort, mypy, Grafana, Loki
Concepts	REST API design, microservices, async task queues, caching, performance optimization, RBAC, JWT/OAuth
Practices	Agile/Scrum, test-driven development, code review, CI/CD, OpenAPI/Swagger documentation, secrets management (SOPS + age)
Spoken Languages	Turkish (native), English (professional working proficiency)

EXPERIENCE

MatFabe Referral Web Application Mar 2026 – Present
Backend Engineer

- Building a referral platform for a private tutoring service (Django, PostgreSQL), live in production with about 100 users.
- Modeled a multi-level referrer network and an ordered outreach pipeline with enforced stage transitions (50+ referrals).
- Work test-first in Scrum iterations; a pytest and factory-boy suite guards every release against regressions.
- Dockerized; GitHub Actions CI/CD ships versioned images to DigitalOcean Container Registry several times a week.

SMGrader.com Oct 2022 – Nov 2025
Backend Engineer

- Built the REST API of an AI-powered grading platform (DRF) and 4 async microservices (Celery, RabbitMQ, Redis).
- Built organization-level RBAC on Django's permission framework; integrated Stripe with per-user token budget logic.
- Built a background job system (hundreds of grading jobs daily) with monitoring, task tracking, and log-based debugging.
- Added graceful cancellation via a Redis flag checked before start; cancelled jobs (15–20% of volume) skip AI calls.
- Cut repeated metadata DB reads about 80% via a Redis read-through cache (TTL) shared across background tasks.
- Loaded SQL, CSV and Excel data into pandas DataFrames for transformation, aggregation, reporting and data handover.
- Built message-level logging and alerting (co-built Grafana/Loki/Slack hooks); failure triage cut from hours to minutes.
- Built a bidirectional Canvas LMS data synchronization integration covering dozens of courses.
- Built services on AWS (RDS, S3, EKS, ElastiCache); deployed through established Jenkins pipelines.
- Assisted the DevOps team on Kubernetes scaling; 5-person engineering team, Scrum sprints, peer code review.

BanaDersBul.com Founded Jan 2021
Founder, Backend Engineer (self-employed)

- Launched a teacher-student marketplace for private lessons, grown to 5,000+ users; own backend and infrastructure.
- Built the backend as a REST API with Flask, SQLAlchemy (Alembic migrations) and PostgreSQL, incl. Full-Text Search.
- Cached search results in Redis keyed by a query hash, cutting repeat search latency from hundreds of ms to tens.
- Implemented JWT auth (logins, secure file downloads, password resets, admin impersonation) and a Flask-Admin panel.
- Migrated from DigitalOcean Kubernetes to a self-managed Docker Compose server, cutting cost from $180 to $40 a month.
- Built one-click GitHub Actions deploys with SOPS + age encrypted secrets; hardened SSH, UFW firewall, fail2ban.
- Shrank Docker images 80%+ (1.14 GB to 199 MB), merged 3 repos into a monorepo; build and push ∼10 to 2 min.

EDUCATION

Istanbul Kultur University Sep 2022 – Jun 2026
B.Sc. Mathematics and Computer Science; mentored student coders ("Patika.dev"), ran Linux community events; Erasmus+ BIP on metacognition in education with EU partner universities (2026); guest author on The Teclado Blog (2022)